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SOUL REVISIONS, THE POLISH PARTITIONS AND THE SETTLEMENT OF NOVOROSSIYA

Population and Towns of the Russian Empire

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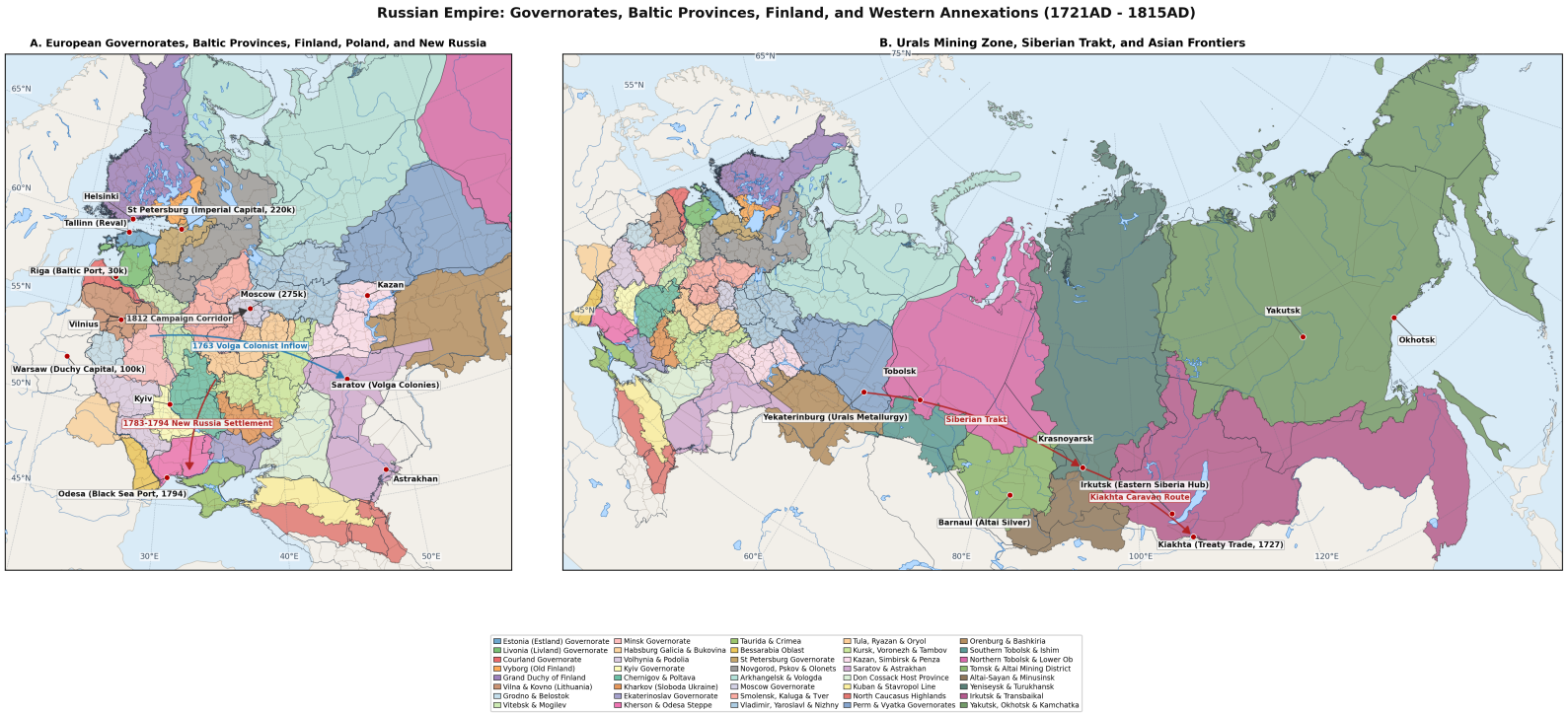


Figure 1. The 40 provinces and frontier regions across the Russian Empire and adjacent Polish-Lithuanian partition lands from 1721AD to 1815AD, showing the Baltic provinces, Finland, the western partition governorates, Novorossiya, Central Russia and Siberia.

Abstract

Between the Peace of Nystad in September 1721AD and the Congress of Vienna in June 1815AD - just before the annexation of Congress Poland - the Russian Empire and its neighbouring partition lands more than doubled in population. Across the 40 provinces and frontier regions covered in this study, total population rose from 23,89M in 1721AD to 51,17M in 1815AD (+114,2%) [1][2][3][4]. Within the borders actually ruled from Saint Petersburg at each date, growth was even faster: the Empire's population nearly tripled from 15,6M at the end of the Great Northern War (1721AD) to 37,4M after the Third Partition of Poland-Lithuania (1795AD) and 47,82M by 1815AD. Half of this gain came from natural increase in the Russian forest-steppe and Volga-Ural basins, and the other half from the conquest of densely settled Polish-Lithuanian provinces in the west and the open Black Sea steppe in the south [2][5][6].

Background

The 40 historical regions span 18,5M km^2 across the Baltic provinces, Finland, the Polish-Lithuanian partition lands (including Austrian Galicia and Bukovina), Ukraine, Bessarabia, European Russia, the North Caucasus and Siberia, whilst excluding Central Asia and Transcaucasia. Within the 39 regions that belonged to the Russian Empire by 1815AD (18,43M km^2, excluding Region 10, Habsburg Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathian Rus, which grew from 1,62M to 3,35M), the population inside constant 1815AD borders rose from 22,26M in 1721AD to 30,12M at the accession of Catherine II in 1762AD, 40,75M after the Third Partition in 1795AD and 47,16M on the eve of Napoleon's invasion in 1811AD, before wartime losses in the west slowed the total to 47,82M in 1815AD (+114,8%) [7][8][9].

The 40-region division follows the provincial and legal boundaries of the eighteenth and early nineteenth centuries (Figure 1; Table 1):

1. **The Baltic Provinces and Finland (Regions 1-5; 481,89k km^2)**: Estland, Livland and Courland under their German noble estates (*Ritterschaften*), together with Old Finland (Vyborg) and the Grand Duchy of Finland annexed from Sweden in 1809AD.
2. **The Western Partition Lands and Galicia (Regions 6-12; 553,38k km^2)**: Lithuania, Belarus and Right-Bank Ukraine annexed during the Three Partitions of Poland-Lithuania (1772AD, 1793AD and 1795AD) and at Tilsit (1807AD), alongside Austrian Galicia and Bukovina (Region 10).
3. **Left-Bank Ukraine, Novorossiya and Bessarabia (Regions 13-18; 417,43k km^2)**: The old Cossack territories of Little Russia (Chernigov and Poltava) and Sloboda Ukraine (Kharkov), together with the newly conquered southern steppes of Ekaterinoslav, Kherson-Odessa, Crimea (Taurida) and Bessarabia.
4. **Capitals, Central Russia, the Volga-Urals and the North Caucasus (Regions 19-33; 4,19M km^2)**: Saint Petersburg and Moscow, the northern forest and lake provinces, the Central Industrial and Central Black-Earth belts, the Middle and Lower Volga, the Don and Kuban Cossack lands, the North Caucasian highlands and the Ural mining provinces of Perm, Vyatka and Orenburg.
5. **Siberia and the North Pacific (Regions 34-40; 12,86M km^2)**: Western Siberia along the Tobolsk post road and northern Ob-Irtysh basin, the Tomsk and Altai silver-mining district, the Sayan borderlands, Yeniseisk, Irkutsk and Transbaikalia, and the far north-eastern expanse of Yakutsk, Okhotsk and Kamchatka.

Methodology

Population estimates across the eight benchmark dates (1721AD, 1744AD, 1762AD, 1782AD, 1795AD, 1806AD, 1811AD and 1815AD) rest on four main bodies of evidence [10][11]. For the Russian interior, the backbone of the series is the sequence of seven Poll-Tax Soul Revisions (*Revizskie skazki*, Revisions I to VII). Ordered by Peter I on 26 November 1718AD to replace the old household tax (*podvornoe oblozhenie*) with a head tax (*podushnaya podat*) on male "revision souls" (*revizskie dushi*), seven counts were carried out between 1719AD and 1816AD [10][11][12]. The First Revision (1719-1724AD, checked by army audit commissions up to 1727AD) and Second Revision (1743-1747AD) counted taxable males only (state, court, church and landlord peasants alongside townsmen), leaving out women, nobles, clergy, regular soldiers and autonomous borderlands such as the Baltic provinces, the Ukrainian Hetmanate and nomadic steppe peoples [1][3]. Starting with the Third Revision (1761-1763AD), Fourth Revision (1781-1782AD, matched to Catherine II's 1775AD provincial reform) and Fifth Revision (1794-1795AD), women were listed alongside men, and the count was extended to the Baltic provinces (*Seelenrevisionen*), Little Russia, Sloboda Ukraine, Novorossiya and the newly annexed Belarusian, Lithuanian and Right-Bank Ukrainian provinces [2][13].

Under wartime pressure in May 1811AD, Alexander I's Sixth Revision reverted to a quick male-only count, whereas the post-war Seventh Revision (ordered in June 1815AD and completed in 1816AD) restored full male and female schedules and registered the heavy losses of the 1812AD campaign [8][9][14][15]. Following Vladimir Kabuzan, Yaroslav Vodarsky and Boris Mironov, total regional populations are calculated from the Senate summary tables (*perechnevye vedomosti*) by doubling male souls where female counts were omitted (using observed regional female-to-male ratios of 1,02-1,06), adding tax-exempt groups (nobles, clergy, officials, retired soldiers and regular troops, usually 4,5-7,5% of provincial totals) and correcting for unrecorded infants and runaways (+18-22% before the military audits of the 1720s, falling to +3-5% by 1782-1795AD and +6-8% during the hurried 1811AD count) [1][16].

Across the north-western provinces (Regions 1-5), the revisions are paired with the Swedish-Finnish *Tabellverket* and Lutheran parish books. In Finland (Region 5), continuous national population tables began in 1749AD under the Royal Swedish *Tabellverket* - the oldest continuous state statistical office in Europe - and carried on without interruption after the Russian conquest of 1809AD [17][18][19]. For 1721AD and 1744AD, Eino Jutikkala, Oiva Turpeinen and Kari Pitkänen worked backward from the 1749AD census using Lutheran communion books (*rippikirjat*) and burial registers [17][20]. In Estland (Region 1), Livland (Region 2) and Courland (Region 3), Heldur Palli and August Wilhelm Hupel cross-checked eighteenth-century ploughland assessments (*Hakenrevisionen* of 1725-1726AD, 1732AD, 1744AD, 1758AD and 1774AD) against Lutheran parish registers before Imperial Soul Revisions began in 1782AD (and 1795AD in Courland) [13][21][22][23]. In Old Finland (Region 4), Russian revision rolls from 1724AD and 1744AD are combined with Karelian Lutheran church books [24].

In the western partition lands (Regions 6-12), estimates before the Three Partitions (1772AD, 1793AD and 1795AD) across Lithuania, Belarus and Right-Bank Ukraine rely on the 1764-1765AD Polish-Lithuanian Jewish poll-tax census, Uniate and Roman Catholic parish visitations, the Four-Year Sejm hearth taxes (*podymne*, 1789-1790AD) and magnate estate inventories studied by Cezary Kuklo, Shaul Stampfer and Arnold Perkovsky [25][26][27][28]. In Austrian Galicia and Bukovina (Region 10), Vienna introduced military-fiscal soul counts immediately after annexation in 1772-1776AD, followed by Emperor Joseph II's patent censuses of 1785-1787AD and the Franciscan updates of 1807-1815AD [29][30].

In the southern and eastern borderlands (Regions 13-18, 29-31 and 34-40), Cossack regimental rolls, steppe land surveys and Siberian fur-tribute (*yasak*) books fill the gaps before regular revisions began. In the Left-Bank Hetmanate (Region 13) and Sloboda Ukraine (Region 14), regimental censuses of 1723-1732AD and Field Marshal Pyotr Rumyantsev's General Survey of Little Russia (*Generalnaya opis Malorossii*, 1765-1769AD) bridge the decades before 1782AD [31][32][33]. Across Novorossiya, Crimea and Bessarabia (Regions 15-18), Ottoman tax estimates, Baron Osip Igelström's 1783-1784AD Taurida survey, Apollon Skalkovsky's Novorossiya chancellery tables and the 1812-1816AD Bessarabian colonist returns document frontier settlement [34][35][36][37]. In the North Caucasus (Region 31) and Siberia (Regions 34-40), Russian revision books for Slavic peasants, mineworkers and Siberian Tatars are combined with *yasak* ledgers and Gerhard Friedrich Müller's expedition surveys [7][38][39][40].

Figure 2 plots total growth alongside ten regional curves, Table 1 sets out the 40-region estimates and Table 2 summarises the seven Soul Revisions and borderland censuses.

Historical Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
1. Estland Governorate	105k	140k	175k	200k	212k	222k	228k	232k	+121%
2. Livland Governorate	195k	280k	385k	495k	550k	585k	605k	615k	+215,4%
3. Courland Governorate	200k	250k	305k	365k	405k	425k	435k	418k	+109%

4. Old Finland / Vyborg Governorate	110k	128k	152k	175k	186k	194k	198k	202k	+83,6%
5. Grand Duchy of Finland	390k	425k	505k	645k	770k	875k	880k	908k	+132,8%
6. Vilna Governorate & Samogitia / Kovno	655k	760k	880k	1,02M	1,11M	1,19M	1,22M	1,11M	+69,5%
7. Grodno Governorate & Belostok Oblast	360k	430k	515k	615k	680k	735k	760k	695k	+93,1%
8. Vitebsk & Mogilev Governorates	610k	740k	910k	1,11M	1,24M	1,34M	1,38M	1,25M	+104,1%
9. Minsk Governorate & Pripyat Polesia	430k	530k	650k	790k	885k	960k	995k	920k	+114%
10. Habsburg Kingdom of Galicia & Lodomeria	1,62M	1,88M	2,22M	2,65M	2,95M	3,16M	3,26M	3,35M	+106,2%
11. Volhynia & Podolia Governorates	1,2M	1,49M	1,88M	2,3M	2,6M	2,78M	2,87M	2,96M	+147,7%
12. Kyiv Governorate	342k	430k	550k	655k	755k	855k	905k	940k	+174,9%
13. Little Russia: Chernigov & Poltava Governorates	1,55M	1,82M	2,18M	2,58M	2,92M	3,16M	3,27M	3,35M	+115,4%
14. Sloboda-Ukrainian / Kharkov Governorate	402k	500k	625k	775k	905k	1,01M	1,06M	1,1M	+173,6%
15. Ekaterinoslav Governorate & Former Zaporozhian Lands	145k	175k	225k	355k	540k	690k	765k	820k	+465,5%
16. Kherson / Nikolaev Governorate & Ochakov Steppe	105k	125k	155k	225k	355k	495k	565k	620k	+490,5%
17. Taurida Governorate	370k	350k	345k	320k	260k	315k	345k	370k	0%

18. Bessarabia Oblast	200k	225k	255k	290k	320k	340k	310k	385k	+92,5%
19. Saint Petersburg Governorate	260k	345k	435k	545k	625k	695k	735k	760k	+192,3%
20. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Governorates	1,16M	1,25M	1,36M	1,51M	1,62M	1,72M	1,75M	1,77M	+53,2%
21. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Governorates	560k	610k	670k	750k	820k	875k	905k	920k	+64,3%
22. Moscow Governorate	725k	795k	885k	985k	1,08M	1,19M	1,24M	1,12M	+54,5%
23. Smolensk, Kaluga & Tver Governorates	1,72M	1,89M	2,11M	2,38M	2,59M	2,78M	2,87M	2,64M	+53,5%
24. Central Non-Black-Earth Governorates: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma & Nizhny Novgorod	2,42M	2,65M	2,96M	3,33M	3,62M	3,89M	4,02M	4,11M	+69,8%
25. Northern Central Black-Earth Governorates: Tula, Ryazan & Oryol	1,58M	1,83M	2,15M	2,58M	2,95M	3,26M	3,42M	3,52M	+122,8%
26. Southern Central Black-Earth Governorates: Kursk, Voronezh & Tambov	1,51M	1,82M	2,24M	2,79M	3,28M	3,71M	3,94M	4,12M	+172,8%
27. Middle Volga Governorates: Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	1,42M	1,66M	1,96M	2,36M	2,72M	3,02M	3,18M	3,29M	+131,7%
28. Saratov & Astrakhan Governorates	480k	560k	690k	860k	1,12M	1,36M	1,49M	1,58M	+229,2%

29. Province of the Don Cossack Host	180k	215k	265k	365k	485k	590k	645k	680k	+277,8%
30. Caucasian Fortified Line, Black Sea Cossack Kuban	120k	135k	155k	215k	310k	410k	465k	505k	+320,8%
31. North Caucasian Highlanders: Circassia, Kabarda, Chechnya & Dagestan Khanates	780k	800k	830k	860k	885k	900k	905k	910k	+16,7%
32. Perm & Vyatka Governorates	685k	830k	1,03M	1,29M	1,53M	1,74M	1,84M	1,92M	+180,3%
33. Orenburg Governorate & Bashkiria	460k	550k	670k	820k	1,01M	1,21M	1,32M	1,4M	+204,3%
34. Tobolsk Governorate South: Siberian Trakt	215k	255k	308k	380k	445k	500k	528k	545k	+153,5%
35. Tobolsk & Narym River North: Tobolsk, Berezov, Surgut & Obdorsk Yasak Tundra	85k	96k	109k	124k	139k	151k	156k	160k	+88,2%
36. Tomsk Governorate	95k	118k	150k	196k	236k	272k	289k	300k	+215,8%
37. Altai-Sayan & Minusinsk Borderlands	75k	74k	82k	95k	106k	117k	122k	125k	+66,7%
38. Yeniseisk Province: Krasnoyarsk Trakt, Angara Portage & Turukhansk Polar North	72k	76k	86k	102k	118k	132k	138k	144k	+100%
39. Irkutsk Governorate & Transbaikal Frontier	142k	134k	152k	181k	209k	232k	243k	252k	+77,5%

40. Yakutsk, Okhotsk Seaboard & Kamchatka Oblast	155k	115k	125k	135k	145k	154k	158k	160k	+3,2%
Sub-Total: Baltic Provinces & Finland (Regions 1-5)	1M	1,22M	1,52M	1,88M	2,12M	2,3M	2,35M	2,38M	+137,5%
Sub-Total: Partitions & Galicia-Bukovina (Regions 6-12)	5,22M	6,26M	7,61M	9,14M	10,22M	11,02M	11,39M	11,22M	+115,1%
Sub-Total: Hetmanate, Novorossiya & Bessarabia (Regions 13-18)	2,78M	3,19M	3,79M	4,54M	5,3M	6,01M	6,32M	6,64M	+139,3%
Sub-Total: Capitals, North & Central Russia (Regions 19-26)	9,93M	11,19M	12,81M	14,87M	16,59M	18,11M	18,88M	18,96M	+90,9%
Sub-Total: Volga, Urals, Don & Caucasus (Regions 27-33)	4,12M	4,75M	5,6M	6,77M	8,06M	9,23M	9,85M	10,29M	+149,3%
Sub-Total: Siberia & North Pacific (Regions 34-40)	839k	868k	1,01M	1,21M	1,4M	1,56M	1,63M	1,69M	+101%
Sub-Total: 39-Region Imperial Bounds (Excl. Reg. 10)	22,26M	25,61M	30,12M	35,77M	40,75M	45,07M	47,16M	47,82M	+114,8%
Grand Total: All 40 Regions (18,5M km^2)	23,89M	27,49M	32,34M	38,42M	43,7M	48,23M	50,42M	51,17M	+114,2%

Table 1. Regional population estimates across all 40 provinces and frontier zones from the First Soul Revision of 1721AD to the Seventh Soul Revision of 1815AD, with sub-totals by geographical division.

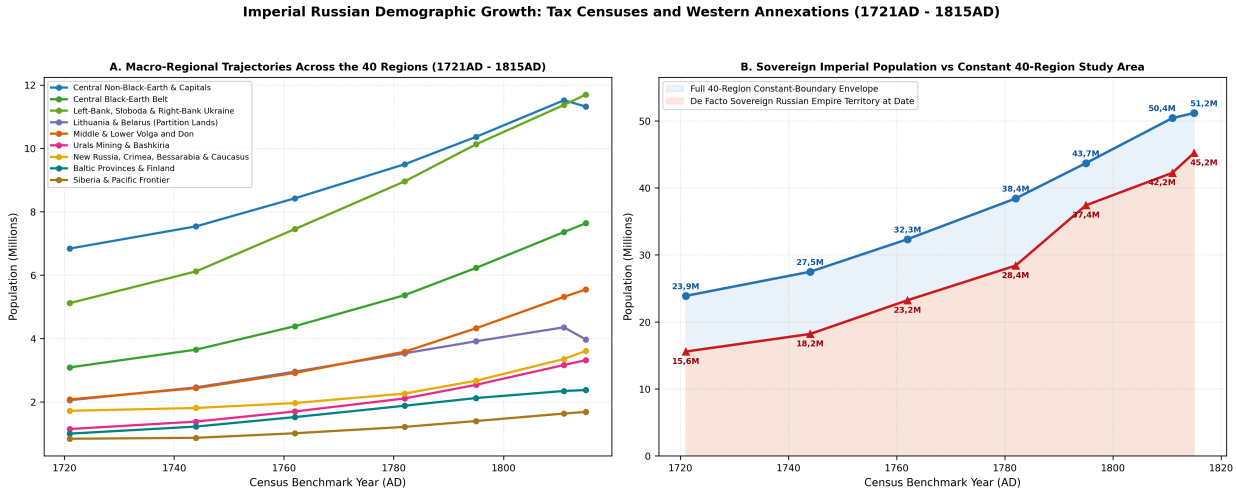


Figure 2. Total population across all 40 regions versus the 39 regions within 1815AD Imperial borders from 1721AD to 1815AD (Panel A), and indexed growth by regional group relative to 1721AD = 100, led by Novorossiya and the Lower Volga (Panel B).

Census or Survey	Benchmark	Registered Scope & Sex Coverage	40-Region Total	Standard Scholarly Adjustments
1st Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1718AD; Audited 1719-1727AD)	1721AD	Taxable males only in Great Russia & Siberia; excludes Ostsee, Hetmanate, nobles	23,89M (22,26M Imp.)	+18-22% early evasion fixed by 1722-1727AD military commissions; x2 sex multiplier + exempted estates
2nd Soul Revision (Decreed Dec 1743AD; Conducted 1744-1747AD)	1744AD	Taxable males only; adds Old Finland (1743AD Abo) & Orenburg Line settlements	27,49M (25,61M Imp.)	+6-9% frontier evasion; x2,03 sex multiplier + clergy/ garrisons (Kabuzan 1963; Vodarsky 1973)
3rd Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1761AD; Conducted 1762-1763AD)	1762AD	Both sexes; still excludes Baltic Ritterschaften & Polish-Lithuanian lands	32,34M (30,12M Imp.)	+4-6% omission; supplemented by 1765-1769AD Rumyantsev Little Russian Survey
4th Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1781AD; Conducted 1781-1782AD)	1782AD	Both sexes across Catherine II's 1775AD namestnichestva, Ostsee, Hetmanate, E. Belarus	38,42M (35,77M Imp.)	+3-4% omission; unified cameral accounting across 41 vicegerencies (Kabuzan 1971)
5th Soul Revision (Decreed Jun 1794AD; Conducted 1794-1795AD)	1795AD	Both sexes across 50 provinces incl. 2nd/ 3rd Polish Partitions, Courland & Crimea	43,7M (40,75M Imp.)	+3-5% omission (+10-15% in newly annexed Jewish kahal rolls; Stampfer 1995)

Governorate Annual Tables & 1806AD Administrative Returns	1806AD	Both sexes via Ministry of Internal Affairs provincial reports & Keppen tables	48,23M (45,07M Imp.)	Reconciled with diocesan vital balances (CBR 48-51, CDR 33-37 per 1k; Hermann 1819)
6th Soul Revision (Decreed May 1811AD; Wartime Male Count)	1811AD	Males only under pre-war fiscal urgency; includes Belostok (1807) & Finland (1809)	50,42M (47,16M Imp.)	Female parity interpolated from 5th/ 7th Revisions; +6-8% hurried wartime undercount (Keppen 1857)
7th Soul Revision (Decreed Jun 1815AD; Conducted 1815-1816AD)	1815AD	Both sexes across post-Vienna Empire incl. Bessarabia (1812AD); captures 1812 losses	51,17M (47,82M Imp.)	Direct measurement of 1812-1814AD excess military/civilian deficits in Regions 3, 6-9, 22-23
Parallel Borderland Censuses (Tabellverket, Commonwealth, Habsburg)	1721-1815AD	Swedish-Finnish Tabellverket (from 1749AD), 1764/1789 Polish rolls, Austrian conscriptions	Anchored in Regions 1-12	Palli (1996), Jutikkala (1965), Kuklo (1999) & Bohachevsky (1967) parish-census syntheses

Table 2. The seven Imperial Soul Revisions and parallel borderland censuses from 1721AD to 1815AD, showing registered population scope, total counts and standard scholarly corrections for omission.

Results

The Baltic Provinces and Finland

Across the north-western Baltic littoral (Regions 1-5, 481,89k km^2), the combined population grew by +137,5% from 1M in 1721AD to 2,38M in 1815AD under institutional regimes distinct from Great Russian serfdom [6][13][17]. Under the Capitulations of Riga and Reval (1710AD), confirmed at the Treaty of Nystad (30 August 1721AD), Peter I guaranteed the Baltic German *Ritterschaften*, Lutheran consistories and Hanseatic magistrate privileges of Estland Governorate (Region 1) and Livland Governorate (Region 2, including Ösel/Saaremaa and South Estonian Dorpat-Pernau alongside Latvian Vidzeme) [21][41]. Both provinces entered 1721AD depleted by the Great Famine of 1695-1697AD, Great Northern War devastation and the 1710-1711AD Baltic bubonic plague, which had killed over half the inhabitants of Reval (Tallinn) and Riga: Estland stood at 105k in 1721AD and Livland at 195k [13][22]. Over the next six decades, the absence of Russian military conscription (until 1797AD), early smallpox variolation, Moravian Brethren (*Herrnhuter*) peasant literacy campaigns and grain-distilling manor expansion fuelled a rapid post-plague recovery [13][23]. Estland more than doubled to 175k in 1762AD, 212k in 1795AD and 232k in 1815AD (+121%), with Reval rising from 5,2k to 12,8k alongside Wesenberg, Hapsal and Weissenstein. Livland more than tripled from 195k in 1721AD to 385k in 1762AD, 550k in 1795AD and 615k in 1815AD (+215,4%), led by Riga - the Empire's second maritime export port after Saint Petersburg - which expanded from 11,8k in 1721AD to 36,5k in 1811AD (dipping slightly to 36k in 1815AD after Governor Essen burned Riga's wooden suburbs against Marshal Macdonald's X Corps in July 1812AD), whilst Dorpat (Tartu, refounded as an Imperial German-language university in 1802AD) grew from 1,8k to 7,5k and Narva, Pernau, Fellin,

Walk and Arensburg anchored coastal and inland trade [21][23]. Alexander I's 1804AD Livland and Estland peasant ordinances regulated corvée (*Fronarbeit*) norms and prepared the personal emancipation enacted in 1816-1819AD [4].

To the south, the Duchy of Courland and Semigallia (Region 3, together with Pilten District) remained a Polish-Lithuanian vassal fief under the Kettler and Biron dukes until its annexation during the Third Partition in March 1795AD [6][7]. Spared the worst fighting of 1710-1721AD, Courland grew steadily from 200k in 1721AD to 305k in 1762AD, 405k at the Fifth Revision in 1795AD and 435k in 1811AD, centred on the ducal capital of Mitau (Jelgava, 5,5k to 12k), the ice-free Baltic port of Libau (Liepaja, 2,8k to 6,2k), Windau (Ventspils), Goldingen and Bauske. In 1812AD, Franco-Prussian occupation, cattle requisitions and typhus reduced Courland's population to 418k by the Seventh Revision in 1815AD (+109% overall) [8].

Across the Gulf of Finland, Karelian and Finnish territories entered the Empire in two stages. Old Finland, organised as Vyborg Governorate (Region 4, growing from 110k to 202k, or +83,6%), was ceded by Sweden in two slices - Karelian Vyborg and Kexholm at Nystad in 1721AD and the Kymi River strip of Hamina (Fredrikshamn), Lappeenranta (Villmanstrand) and Savonlinna (Nyslott) at the Treaty of Åbo in 1743AD - rising from 110k in 1721AD to 152k in 1762AD and 198k in 1811AD [24]. Unlike mainland Sweden-Finland, large tracts of Old Finland were granted as imperial *lahjoitusmaat* ("donation estates") to Russian court aristocrats, depressing peasant mobility relative to Swedish Savo-Karelia until Alexander I reunited Vyborg Governorate with the autonomous Grand Duchy of Finland on 1 January 1812AD, reaching 202k in 1815AD with Vyborg town at 3,8k alongside Sortavala, Kexholm and Hamina [17][24].

In the Grand Duchy of Finland (Region 5, expanding from 390k to 908k, or +132,8%), recovery from the demographic trough of the 1713-1721AD Russian occupation (*Isoviha*, 390k in 1721AD) and the 1741-1743AD *Pikkuviha* war (425k in 1744AD) was driven by pioneering land clearance (*isojaot* enclosure, tar-burning in Ostrobothnia and slash-and-burn *kaski* farming in Savonia), lifting the *Tabellverket* registers to 505k in 1762AD, 645k in 1782AD, 770k in 1795AD and 875k in 1806AD [17][18]. During the Finnish War of 1808-1809AD, epidemic dysentery, typhus and relapsing fever spread along military supply routes, pushing Finland's crude death rate above 55-60 per 1k in 1808-1809AD and causing roughly 35k-45k excess civilian deaths [19][20]. Consequently, Region 5 plateaued at 880k in 1811AD after annexation under the Diet of Borgå (Porvoo) and Treaty of Fredrikshamn (17 September 1809AD), before rebounding to 908k by 1815AD. In April 1812AD, Alexander I transferred the Grand Duchy's capital from Swedish-oriented Åbo (Turku, Finland's largest town at 11,6k in 1815AD) to Helsingfors (Helsinki, 4,8k, guarded by Sveaborg sea fortress), alongside Uleåborg (Oulu, 3,8k), Vasa (9k), Björneborg (Pori, 2,8k) and Tammerfors (Tampere) [17].

The Polish Partitions and Galicia

The centrepiece of Catherine II's western policy was the three-stage partition of the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth (1772AD, 1793AD and 1795AD), followed by Napoleon's cession of Belostok (Bialystok) Oblast to Russia at the Treaty of Tilsit in July 1807AD [6][25][42]. Across Regions 6-12 (553,38k km^2), the combined population rose by +115,1% from 5,22M in 1721AD to a pre-war peak of 11,39M in 1811AD before contracting to 11,22M in 1815AD under the impact of the 1812AD campaign in Lithuania and Belarus (Table 3).

Chronology & Event	Primary Regions	Effect on Population	Key Literature
1721AD Nystad & 1743AD Abo Treaties (Baltic & Old Finland)	Regions 1, 2 & 4	Incorporates 410k inhabitants (1721AD) + 55k (1743AD); rapid post-1710 plague rebound	Palli 1996; Kashchenko 2016

1762-1766AD Foreign Colonist Manifestos (Volga Germans)	Region 28 (Saratov)	27k-30k German colonists settled in 104 Volga colonies (1764-1768AD), reaching 62k by 1815AD	Bartlett 1979; Galperina 2013
1768-1769AD Kamchatka & Okhotsk Smallpox Pandemic	Region 40 (Kamchatka)	Kills 5k-6k Itelmen/Koryaks (50-65% of Peninsula natives); Reg. 40 held at 125k-135k	Turaev 2012; Tolkacheva 2015
1770-1772AD Russian Plague & Sep 1771AD Moscow Plague Riot	Regions 12, 22, 23 & 25	56k-70k dead in Moscow city (100k+ in Moscow & central uezds); temporary flight halves city	Alexander 1980; Iskhakov 2013
Jan 1771AD Torghut Kalmyk Exodus (Pylnyy pokhod)	Region 28 (Astrakhan)	31k-33k tents (150k-170k Kalmyks) depart east of Volga; >85k perish en route to Qing Ili	Khodarkovsky 1992; Ochirov 2012
1772AD, 1793AD & 1795AD Partitions + 1807AD Belostok	Regions 3 & 6-12	Transfers 7,3M Commonwealth subjects to Russia (Regs 3, 6-9, 11-12) & 2,65M to Austria (Reg 10)	Kabuzan 1990; Kuklo 2009; Klier 1986
1773-1775AD Pugachev Rebellion (Yaik, Orenburg, Volga, Urals)	Regions 27, 28, 32 & 33	25k-40k military/civilian deaths; burning of 60+ Ural foundries & Bashkir frontier forts	Kahan 1985; Shaykhislamov 2018
1774-1792AD Novorossiya, 1778AD Mariupol Greeks & 1783AD Crimea	Regions 15, 16, 17 & 30	31k Crimean Christians to Mariupol (1778); 100k-180k Tatars emigrate; >600k colonists arrive	Kabuzan 1976; Williams 2001; Pakhomenko 2014
1808-1809AD Finnish War & Sep 1809AD Fredrikshamn Annexation	Regions 4 & 5	35k-45k war-epidemic deaths in Finland; transfers 880k inhabitants into autonomous Grand Duchy	Jutikkala 1965; Pitkanen 1993
May 1812AD Treaty of Bucharest (Bessarabia Oblast Annexation)	Region 18 (Bessarabia)	Annexes 47,08k km^2 (310k in 1811AD to 385k in 1815AD) via Bulgarian, Gagauz & Moldavian inflows	Feldman 2023; Bas 2015
Jun-Dec 1812AD Patriotic War (Grande Armee Invasion & Retreat)	Regions 3, 6-9, 22 & 23	500k-650k net civilian/ military deficit across Lithuania-Belarus (-380k) & Smolensk-Moscow (-345k)	Lieven 2009; Shelomentseva 2015; Kabuzan 1992

Table 3. Major territorial annexations, foreign colonist settlements, epidemics and military campaigns affecting regional population growth between 1721AD and 1815AD.

In eastern Belarus, the Vitebsk and Mogilev Governorates (Region 8, rising from 610k in 1721AD to 1,38M in 1811AD and 1,25M in 1815AD, or +104,1%) were annexed by Russia in the First Partition of August 1772AD. Initially organised as the Pskov/Polotsk and Mogilev governorates alongside Polish *Inflanty* (Latgale) around Dünaburg (Daugavpils), and briefly merged as Belarus Governorate in 1796-1802AD,

Region 8 doubled from 610k in 1721AD to 1,11M at the Fourth Revision in 1782AD and 1,38M in 1811AD [2][43]. Dense networks of market towns (*miasteczka* or *shtetlekh*) such as Shklov (10,5k), Orsha (5,4k), Mstislavl and Polotsk (9,6k) grew alongside Vitebsk (15,4k in 1811AD) and Mogilev (16,3k in 1811AD) [26][28]. Between June and November 1812AD, however, Region 8 formed the main path for both the French advance and the Berezina retreat through Borisov, Orsha and Vitebsk, suffering requisitioning, famine and typhus that cut its population by 135k (-9,8%) to 1,25M in 1815AD [8][42].

Across Lithuania, Grodno-Belostok and central Belarus (Regions 6, 7 and 9), similar wartime losses interrupted decades of steady growth. Vilna Governorate and Samogitia/Kovno (Region 6), annexed in the Third Partition of 1795AD, grew from 655k in 1721AD to 1,11M in 1795AD and 1,22M in 1811AD, anchored by Vilna (Vilnius) - the largest city of the former Grand Duchy of Lithuania, rising from 19,5k in 1721AD to 42k in 1811AD around its university (rechartered in 1803AD) and Jewish *kahal* - alongside Kovno (Kaunas, 8,3k), Shavli (Siauliai, 3,8k), Telshi and Ponevezh [25][26]. Between June and December 1812AD, Vilna served as Napoleon's rear supply base and the graveyard of tens of thousands of freezing *Grande Armée* stragglers and typhus-stricken townspeople; Vilna city fell from 42k to 36k and Region 6 lost 110k (-9%) between 1811AD and 1815AD, returning to 1,11M [8][42]. Grodno Governorate and Belostok Oblast (Region 7, annexed in 1795AD and at Tilsit in 1807AD) expanded from 360k in 1721AD to 760k in 1811AD before dropping by 8,6% to 695k in 1815AD around Grodno (9,1k), Belostok (6k), Brest-Litovsk (7,2k), Slonim, Novogrudok and Lida, whilst Minsk Governorate and Pripyat Polesia (Region 9, annexed in the 1793AD Second Partition) grew from 430k in 1721AD to 995k in 1811AD and dropped by 7,5% to 920k in 1815AD after fighting around Minsk (11,8k), Borisov, Bobruisk fortress (6,2k), Slutsk (6,9k) and Pinsk (5,7k) [8][43].

To the south, in Right-Bank Ukraine (Regions 11 and 12), following the eighteenth-century *Haidamak* uprisings (*Koliivshchyna* in 1768AD, centred on Uman) and Polish noble estate settlement across the Podolian and Volhynian forest-steppe, the Second (1793AD) and Third (1795AD) Partitions brought the Volhynia and Podolia Governorates (Region 11, rising from 1,2M to 2,96M, or +147,7%) and Kyiv Governorate (Region 12, uniting Russian Left-Bank Kyiv city with the annexed Right-Bank interior, rising from 342k to 940k, or +174,9%) into the Empire [27][33]. Spared direct occupation by Napoleon's main army in 1812AD, Volhynia-Podolia and Kyiv continued growing between 1811AD and 1815AD (from 2,87M to 2,96M and from 905k to 940k), led by Kyiv (14,8k to 23,4k), Berdichev (16k, a major centre of Volhynian banking and Hasidic trade), Kamenets-Podolskiy (13,8k), Zhitomir (10,8k), Dubno (8,7k), Uman (10,6k), Belaya Tserkov (7,7k) and Cherkassy (5,9k) [27][44]. To keep Jewish merchants registered in the annexed western towns from competing with Christian guilds in Moscow and inner Russia, Catherine II's decree of 23 December 1791AD and Alexander I's *Jewish Statute* of 9 December 1804AD established the Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement across Lithuania, Belarus, Right-Bank and Left-Bank Ukraine and Novorossiya (holding roughly 750k-900k Jewish inhabitants by 1806-1815AD), whilst Catherine II's 1794-1796AD campaigns transferred roughly 1,5M Right-Bank and Belarusian Greek Catholics (Uniates) to the Russian Orthodox Church [26][28][45].

In the Habsburg Kingdom of Galicia and Lodomeria, Bukovina and Carpathian Rus (Region 10, growing from 1,62M to 3,35M, or +106,2%), which is included to maintain geographic continuity across the partitioned lands, Eastern Galicia (annexed by Austria in 1772AD), Bukovina (taken from the Ottoman Empire in 1775AD) and Hungarian Subcarpathian Rus doubled from 1,62M in 1721AD to 2,65M under the Josephine censuses (1782AD benchmark) and 3,35M in 1815AD [29][30]. The provincial capital Lemberg (Lviv) expanded from 25k in 1721AD to 44,5k in 1815AD - making it the third largest city in the 40-region area - alongside the duty-free border market of Brody (7,5k to 19,5k), Stanislau (10,1k), Tarnopol (9,8k), Drohobych (8,9k), Czernowitz (Chernivtsi, 1,8k to 6,8k) and Ungvár (Uzhhorod, 5,5k) [25][30].

Ukraine, Novorossiya and Bessarabia

Few parts of eighteenth-century Europe changed more rapidly in political geography and rural settlement than the Ukrainian forest-steppe and Black Sea coast (Regions 13-18, 417,43k km^2), which grew by +139,3% from 2,78M in 1721AD to 6,64M in 1815AD [33][35][46]. Figure 3 shows the provincial growth rankings and regional population shares across the 40 regions.

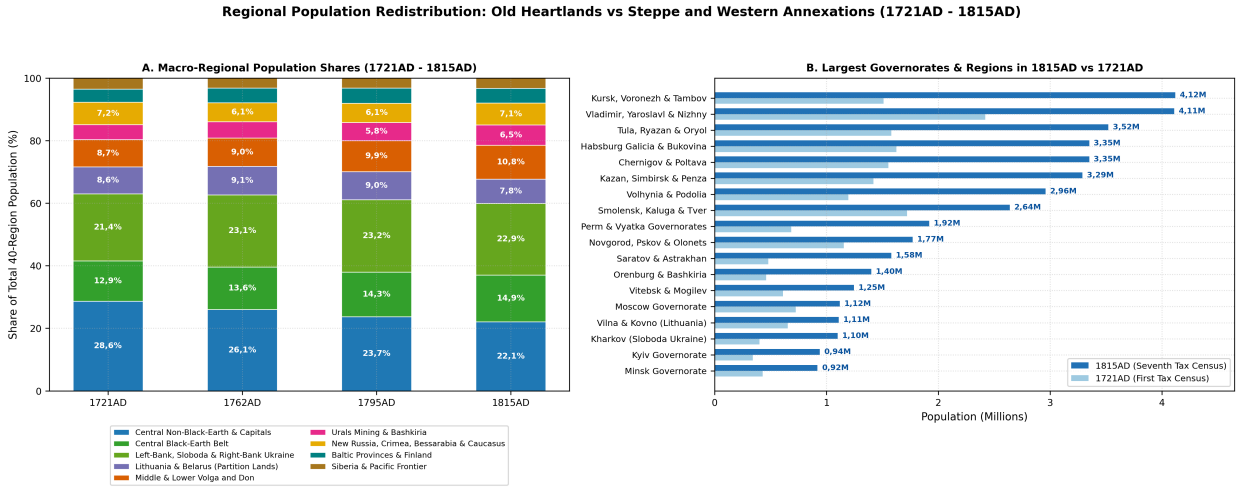


Figure 3. Fastest-growing provinces ranked by percentage gain from 1721AD to 1815AD, led by Kherson, Ekaterinoslav and the Caucasian Line (Panel A), and changing regional shares of total population across the seven Soul Revisions (Panel B).

In the old Ukrainian Cossack lands, Saint Petersburg abolished autonomous regimental rule and brought the population into the regular poll-tax and serf system across Little Russia (Chernigov and Poltava Governorates, Region 13, rising from 1,55M to 3,35M, or +115,4%) and Sloboda Ukraine (Kharkov Governorate, Region 14, rising from 402k to 1,1M, or +173,6%). Catherine II abolished the five Sloboda Cossack regiments in July 1765AD, creating the Sloboda-Ukrainian Governorate around Kharkov, where Vasily Karazin founded Kharkov University in 1804-1805AD as the town grew from 6,2k in 1721AD to 13,5k in 1815AD alongside Akhtyrka, Sumy, Izyum and Chuguev [32]. In Left-Bank Little Russia, the office of Hetman Kirill Razumovsky was abolished in November 1764AD, Rumyantsev's General Survey counted Cossack and peasant households in 1765-1769AD, regimental rule gave way to provinces in 1781AD and the decree of 3 May 1783AD prohibited peasant movement, legally binding Left-Bank peasants (*pospoliti*) to the Cossack officer gentry (*starshina*, ennobled in 1785AD), whilst registered Little Russian Cossacks survived as a large class of free smallholders [31][47]. Dense farming pushed Region 13 to 3,35M (31,4 inhabitants per km^2) by 1815AD around Nezhin (14k, home to a privileged Greek merchant colony), Poltava (10,2k), Chernigov, Glukhov, Kremenchug and Starodub [33].

South of the forest-steppe, Russo-Ottoman victories transformed the sparsely inhabited "Wild Field" (*Dikoe pole*) and Crimean Khanate into Novorossiya ("New Russia") and Bessarabia [34][46][48]. Across Ekaterinoslav Governorate (Region 15, surging from 145k to 820k, or +465,5%) and the Kherson/Ochakov steppe (Region 16, rising from 105k to 620k, or +490,5%), colonisation began in the 1750s with Empress Elizabeth's military settlements of New Serbia (1752AD, anchored by Fort Saint Elizabeth/Elisavetgrad) and Slavo-Serbia (1753AD, around Bakhmut and the Lugansk foundry, established in 1795AD), which absorbed Serbian, Vlach, Bulgarian and Ukrainian settlers despite Crimean Tatar raids such as Khan Qirim Giray's January 1769AD incursion [35][49]. Following the Treaty of Küçük Kaynarca (July 1774AD),

Catherine II ordered General Pyotr Tekeli to surround and abolish the Zaporozhian Sich in June 1775AD, redistributing steppe estates under Prince Grigory Potemkin's vicegerency [48][50]. After the Treaty of Jassy (January 1792AD, Old Style December 1791AD) extended Russian rule across the Yedisan/Ochakov steppe between the Southern Bug and Dniester, state peasants, fugitive Great Russian and Ukrainian serfs, Chortitza (1789AD) and Molotschna (1804AD) Prussian Mennonites, Black Sea German Lutheran and Catholic colonists (Liebental and Kutschurgan), Ottoman Bulgarians and Greeks settled across Regions 15 and 16 [51][52][53]. A network of planned ports and administrative capitals rose within two decades: Kherson (founded in 1778AD as a Black Sea shipyard, 12,8k in 1815AD), Mariupol (founded in 1778-1780AD by ~31k Crimean Rumelian and Urum Greeks relocated from the Crimean Khanate under Metropolitan Ignatios to weaken the Khanate's tax base) [54], Ekaterinoslav (Dnipro, refounded on the Dnieper right bank in 1787AD, 8,2k in 1815AD), Nikolaev (Admiralty dockyard founded in 1789AD, 10,5k) and Odessa (decreed in May 1794AD on the site of Ottoman Khadzhibey), which under Duc de Richelieu's governorship (1803-1814AD) and Mediterranean wheat exports grew rapidly from 1,1k in 1782AD and 4,5k in 1795AD to 35k in 1815AD [53][55].

In Taurida Governorate, covering Crimea and Northern Tavria (Region 17, moving from 370k in 1721AD to 260k in 1795AD and back to 370k in 1815AD, or 0% net), population followed a V-shaped trajectory across the late eighteenth century [36][56]. Weakened by Russian invasions (1736-1738AD and 1771AD), the 1778AD departure of ~31k Crimean Greeks and Armenians [54] and Catherine II's annexation of the Crimean Khanate on 8 April 1783AD, between 100k and 180k Crimean Tatars and Nogais emigrated by sea and across the Danube to Ottoman Dobruja and Anatolia between 1783AD and 1793AD [36][56]. Consequently, Region 17 contracted from ~370k in 1721AD and 320k in 1782AD to a Fifth Revision low of 260k in 1795AD, with the old Giray capital of Bakhchisarai shrinking from 14k in 1721AD to 6,8k in 1795AD and Karasubazar from 10,5k to 6,2k. Between 1795AD and 1815AD, state peasant settlement in the mainland Melitopol-Dnieper uezds, Nogai pacification on the Molochnaya steppe, German and Bulgarian colonies and naval expansion at Sevastopol (founded in 1783AD at Akhtiar, rising to 14k including naval ratings by 1815AD), Simferopol (founded in 1784AD beside Aqmescit, 4,8k), Feodosia (Kaffa) and Evpatoria restored Taurida's total population to 370k by 1815AD [35][36].

Further west, Bessarabia Oblast (Region 18, growing from 200k in 1721AD to 310k in 1811AD and 385k in 1815AD, or +92,5%) was ceded by the Ottoman Empire at the Treaty of Bucharest (28 May 1812AD) four weeks before Napoleon crossed the Niemen. The interfluve between the Prut, Dniester and Black Sea combined Moldavian boyar and freeholder uplands around Kishinev (Chisinau) and Orhei with the southern Budjak steppe around Bender, Akkerman, Izmail, Kiliya and Khotin [37][52]. During the 1806-1812AD Russo-Ottoman War, Russian expulsion of the Budjak Nogai horde (~25k-35k) briefly depressed Region 18 from 340k in 1806AD to 310k in 1811AD; immediately after 1812AD, tax exemptions, freedom from serfdom and Trans-Danubian Bulgarian, Gagauz, Moldavian, Ukrainian and Warsaw-Duchy German colonist inflows lifted Bessarabia to 385k by 1815AD (+24,2% in four years), whilst the new oblast capital Kishinev more than doubled from 7,5k in 1811AD to 18k in 1815AD [8][37].

Central Russia, the Volga-Urals and the Caucasus

Across the Great Russian interior, the Volga-Ural basin and the North Caucasian frontier (Regions 19-33, 4,19M km^2), the total population rose from 14,05M in 1721AD to 29,25M in 1815AD (+108,1%), as the Empire's demographic weight shifted southward and eastward out of the northern forest belt toward the Black-Earth provinces, the Lower Volga, the Ural ironworks and the Kuban-Terek frontier lines [2][4][47]. Figure 4 and Table 4 trace the growth of the Empire's leading towns between 1721AD and 1815AD.

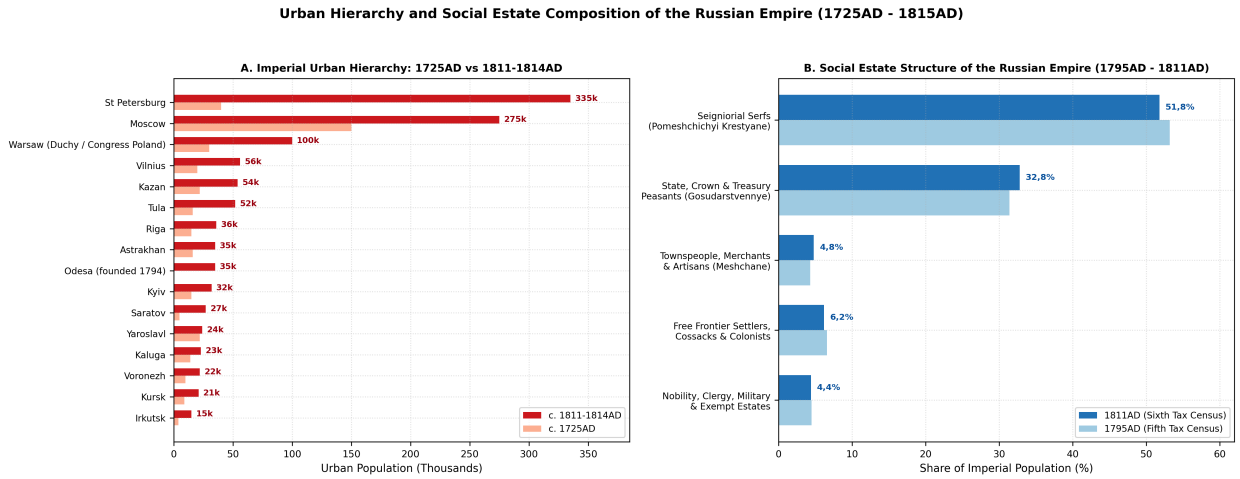


Figure 4. Population of the eighteen largest cities in 1721AD and 1815AD (Panel A), and the divergent trajectories of Saint Petersburg, Moscow (showing the 1771AD plague and 1812AD fire) and the rising Black Sea and Baltic ports from 1721AD to 1815AD (Panel B).

Rank (1815)	City & Region	1721AD	1762AD	1795AD	1811AD	1815AD	Role and Growth
No. 1	Saint Petersburg (Reg. 19)	40k	130k	225k	300k	335k	Imperial capital, court, Baltic port & guard garrisons (+737,5%)
No. 2	Moscow (Reg. 22)	140k	165k	215k	275k	185k	Old capital & textile hub; 1771 plague & Sep 1812 Fire (-32,7% vs 1811)
No. 3	Lviv/Lemberg (Reg. 10)	25k	30k	38,5k	43k	44,5k	Habsburg Galician crownland capital & commercial centre (+78%)
No. 4	Riga (Reg. 2)	11,8k	21,2k	30,8k	36,5k	36k	Baltic Livland capital & Daugava flax/timber port (+205,1%)
No. 5	Vilna/Vilnius (Reg. 6)	19,5k	26k	35,5k	42k	36k	Lithuanian capital & university; 1812 typhus/retreat loss (-14,3% vs 1811)
No. 6	Astrakhan (Reg. 28)	15k	22,5k	30k	34,2k	35,2k	Caspian/Persian silk & Volga fisheries entrepot (+134,7%)
No. 7	Odessa (Reg. 16)	-	0,8k	4,5k	24k	35k	Founded 1794AD on Khadzhibey; Black Sea grain port

No. 8	Kazan (Reg. 27)	18k	24,5k	29,5k	33,4k	34,2k	Middle Volga administrative, leather/soap & university (1804) hub
No. 9	Tula (Reg. 25)	16k	22k	28k	31,5k	32,5k	Imperial small-arms arsenal & iron/samovar workshops (+103,1%)
No. 10	Kronstadt (Reg. 19)	8,5k	16,5k	24,5k	29,5k	31k	Baltic Fleet island fortress & merchant customs roadstead
No. 11	Saratov (Reg. 28)	8k	13,5k	21,5k	26k	27,4k	Lower Volga salt/ grain port & 1764 Volga German colony centre
No. 12	Yaroslavl (Reg. 24)	16k	19k	22,2k	24k	24,4k	Upper Volga linen manufactories & river transshipment (+52,5%)
No. 13	Kyiv (Reg. 12)	14,8k	18,2k	20,9k	22,6k	23,4k	Dnieper pilgrimage metropolis & Contract Fair (from 1797AD)
No. 14	Kaluga (Reg. 23)	12,8k	16,5k	20,8k	23,6k	23k	Oka grain/hemp river port & 1812 Russian rear depot (+79,7%)
No. 15	Oryol (Reg. 25)	9,5k	13,8k	18,8k	21,8k	22,5k	Oka head-of-navigation grain shipper to St Petersburg (+136,8%)
No. 16	Kursk (Reg. 26)	10,2k	14,5k	18,5k	20,7k	21,4k	Black-Earth guberniya seat & Korennaya Fair (+109,8%)
No. 17	Voronezh (Reg. 26)	11k	14k	17,5k	19,6k	20,2k	Don shipyard cradle & southern chernozem market (+83,6%)

No. 18	Kishinev (Reg. 18)	4,5k	6k	7,8k	7,5k	18k	Bessarabia Oblast capital after May 1812 annexation (+300%)

Table 4. The eighteen largest cities across the 40 regions in 1815AD, showing their population growth across five revision benchmarks from 1721AD to 1815AD and their main economic roles.

The Capitals, the 1771AD Plague and the Black-Earth Shift

Founded in 1703AD and confirmed at Nystad in 1721AD, Saint Petersburg Governorate (Region 19) grew by +192,3% from 260k in 1721AD to 760k in 1815AD [5][44]. Sustained by compulsory noble residence, the Baltic Fleet at Kronstadt (8,5k to 31k), preferential customs tariffs over Arkhangelsk and seasonal peasant migrant workers (*otkhodniki*), Saint Petersburg city surged more than eightfold from 40k in 1721AD to 130k in 1762AD, 225k in 1795AD (overtaking Moscow as Russia's largest city), 300k in 1811AD and 335k in 1815AD [4][44]. Supplying the northern capital with interior grain, iron and naval timber drove canal building across the Novgorod, Pskov and Olonets Governorates (Region 20, rising from 1,16M to 1,77M, or +53,2%) - via the Vyshny Volochyok waterway, the Ladoga bypass canals and the Tikhvin and Mariinsk systems opened in 1810-1811AD, alongside Charles Gascoigne's Alexandrovsky cannon foundry at Petrozavodsk (4,8k in 1815AD) - whilst the Arkhangelsk and Vologda Governorates (Region 21, growing from 560k to 920k, or +64,3%) expanded more slowly after Peter I diverted foreign trade from White Sea Arkhangelsk (10k to 11,8k, partly reopened by Catherine II in 1762AD) [3][5].

In central Russia, Moscow Governorate (Region 22) rose from 725k in 1721AD to 885k in 1762AD before suffering the deadliest urban epidemic of eighteenth-century Europe: the Bubonic Plague of 1770-1772AD [57][58]. Brought from the Moldavian-Wallachian war theatre into Moscow's woollen cloth mills (*Sukonnyy dvor*) in late 1770AD, deaths peaked at over 800-1k per day in August-September 1771AD, sparking the Plague Riot (*Chumnoy bunt*) of 15-17 September 1771AD and the murder of Archbishop Ambrosius at the Donskoy Monastery before Count Grigory Orlov enforced quarantines and extra-mural plague cemeteries [57][58]. Between 56k and 70k inhabitants perished in Moscow city (over a quarter of its winter population, and ~100k across Moscow Governorate and neighbouring districts), slowing Region 22's growth between 1762AD (885k) and 1782AD (985k) before rural textile migration lifted Moscow city to 275k and Moscow Governorate to 1,24M by 1811AD [44]. Across the Central Non-Black-Earth Industrial Belt of Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma and Nizhny Novgorod (Region 24, rising from 2,42M to 4,11M, or +69,8%), poorer forest soils and cash-quitrent (*obrok*) serfdom encouraged linen, cotton-printing and metalworking villages around Yaroslavl (24,4k), Nizhny Novgorod (16,8k), Kostroma (10,8k), Shuia-Ivanovo and Pavlovo-on-Oka [5][47]. Conversely, fertile black-earth soils and demesne labour (*barshchina*) supported much faster agricultural expansion across the Northern Black-Earth provinces of Tula, Ryazan and Oryol (Region 25, growing from 1,58M to 3,52M, or +122,8%) - led by Tula (16k to 32,5k) and Oryol (9,5k to 22,5k) - and the Southern Black-Earth provinces of Kursk, Voronezh and Tambov (Region 26, rising from 1,51M to 4,12M, or +172,8%), where Kursk (21,4k), Voronezh (20,2k) and Tambov (12,6k) served as major grain and livestock markets [2][15].

The War of 1812AD

Between 24 June and December 1812AD, Napoleon's ~610k *Grande Armée* advanced and retreated along the Niemen-Dvina-Dnieper-Moskva road, inflicting a sharp population loss between the Sixth Revision (1811AD) and Seventh Revision (1815AD) [8][42][59]. Across the seven directly invaded western and central

regions (Regions 3, 6, 7, 8, 9, 22 and 23), the combined population fell by 727k between 1811AD (8,89M) and 1815AD (8,17M), a net drop of 8,2%, or roughly a 900k-1,1M total deficit once four years of lost natural increase and military deaths among the >900k recruits and militiamen (*opolchenie*) raised in 1812-1814AD are included [8][42].

In the Smolensk, Kaluga and Tver Governorates (Region 23), the population fell from 2,87M in 1811AD to 2,64M in 1815AD (-230k, or -8%). Bearing the brunt of the August battle and burning of Smolensk (falling from 12,6k in 1811AD to 8,8k in 1815AD), Vyazma (7,8k to 6,2k), Dorogobuzh, Gzhatsk and the October battle of Maloyaroslavets in Kaluga Governorate, Smolensk Governorate alone lost 160k-190k inhabitants to flight, scorched-earth destruction and typhus [59]. In Moscow Governorate (Region 22), the population dropped from 1,24M in 1811AD to 1,12M in 1815AD (-115k, or -9,3%). After the Battle of Borodino (7 September 1812AD), civilian evacuation reduced Moscow's resident population below 15k-25k when French troops entered on 14 September, and the Fire of Moscow (14-18 September 1812AD) destroyed ~6,5k of the city's ~9,2k houses (over 70% of its buildings). By 1815AD, Moscow city stood at 185k - still 90k (-32,7%) below its 1811AD pre-war peak of 275k [42][44].

The Volga, the Urals and the Caucasus

Along the Middle and Lower Volga (Regions 27 and 28), settlement expanded rapidly across the eighteenth century. The Kazan, Simbirsk and Penza Governorates (Region 27, growing from 1,42M to 3,29M, or +131,7%) combined Russian noble estates with Volga Tatar, Chuvash, Mordvin and Mari state peasants, including the Admiralty ship-timber cutters (*lashmany*) around Kazan (18k to 34,2k, seat of Kazan University from 1804AD), Simbirsk (13,2k) and Penza (11,8k) [6][60]. Southward in the Saratov and Astrakhan Governorates (Region 28, rising from 480k to 1,58M, or +229,2%), two opposite movements took place within eight years. Under Catherine II's Foreign Colonist Manifestos of December 1762AD and July 1763AD, 27k-30k German colonists from Hesse, the Palatinate and Württemberg settled between 1764AD and 1768AD in 104 colonies on both banks of the Volga around Saratov (8k to 27,4k), Katharinenstadt, Pokrovskaya and Sarepta (a Moravian settlement near Tsaritsyn, founded in 1765AD); aided by religious freedom, tax holidays and exemption from conscription, the Volga Germans grew through natural increase to ~62k by 1815AD [51][61]. Conversely, advancing Russian settlement lines and curbs on khanate autonomy provoked Ubashi Khan's Kalmyk Exodus (*Torghutskiy ukhod*) of 5 January 1771AD: roughly 31k-33k tents (~150k-170k Kalmyks) on the eastern bank of the Volga set out across the Kazakh steppe toward Qing Dzungaria (Ili), losing over half their people and herds to winter cold, disease and Kazakh and Kyrgyz raids along the way (~70k-75k survivors reached Qing territory), whilst a mild winter left the Volga unfrozen and trapped ~11k-13k tents (~55k Kalmyks) on the western bank in Astrakhan Governorate (Astrakhan rising from 15k to 35,2k), whose autonomous Kalmyk Khanate Catherine II abolished in October 1771AD [62][63][64].

In the Urals and Bashkiria (Regions 32 and 33), ironmining and frontier rebellion shaped regional growth. Under Peter I's mining decrees (including the 1721AD law allowing merchants to buy whole villages bound to factories) and the expansion of the Demidov and Stroganov works, the Perm and Vyatka Governorates (Region 32, growing from 685k to 1,92M, or +180,3%) became the world's leading exporter of pig iron in the second half of the eighteenth century [5][65][66]. Over 210k state "ascribed peasants" (*pripisnye krestyane*, required to cut charcoal timber and haul ore in place of poll tax) and factory serfs clustered around Ekaterinburg (founded in 1723AD, 11,2k in 1815AD), Nizhny Tagil (13,8k), Perm (6,8k), Kungur, Solikamsk, Vyatka (6,2k) and the Izhevsk arms works (founded in 1760AD and turned into an imperial musket arsenal in 1807AD, 9,5k) [65][66]. Southward in Orenburg Governorate and Bashkiria (Region 33, expanding from 460k to 1,4M, or +204,3%), the building of the Orenburg Fortified Line in 1735-1743AD (Orenburg at 10,8k, Ufa at 8,4k, Chelyabinsk, Troitsk and Sterlitamak) provoked repeated Bashkir uprisings (1735-1740AD and 1755AD) and culminated in Yemelyan Pugachev's Rebellion (September

1773AD to January 1775AD), which united Yaik (renamed Ural) Cossacks, Bashkirs under Salavat Yulaev, Ural foundrymen, Old Believers and Volga serfs from Orenburg and Kazan down to Saratov and Tsaritsyn, burning over 60 Ural ironworks and killing ~25k-40k people before fresh peasant and landlord settlement tripled Region 33's population by 1815AD [5][67].

Across the southern steppes and mountains (Regions 29, 30 and 31), the Don Cossack Host Province (Region 29, rising from 180k to 680k, or +277,8%) expanded through Cossack natural increase, runaway Ukrainian and Russian peasant settlement (registered to Don officer estates in 1796AD), Taganrog port (refounded in 1769AD, 8,8k in 1815AD), Nakhichevan-on-Don (founded in 1779AD by Crimean Armenians resettled alongside the Mariupol Greeks, 9,2k) and Ataman Matvei Platov's move of the Host capital from flood-prone Cherkassk to Novocherkassk in 1805AD (8,5k in 1815AD) [2][46]. Along the Azov-Mozdok Fortified Line built in 1777-1780AD, Caucasian Governorate (Georgievsk, Stavropol and Kuban, Region 30, growing from 120k to 505k, or +320,8%) combined garrison towns at Kizlyar (founded in 1735AD, 9,2k), Mozdok (1763AD), Georgievsk (1777AD) and Stavropol (1777AD, 5,5k) with Catherine II's 1792-1793AD resettlement of ~25k former Zaporozhian Black Sea Cossacks to the right bank of the Kuban River around Ekaterinodar (Krasnodar, founded in 1793AD, 4,8k) [46][68]. South of the Kuban and Terek rivers, the North Caucasian highlanders of Circassia, Kabarda, Chechnya and Dagestan (Region 31, rising from 780k to 910k, or +16,7%) remained largely outside Russian rule (apart from Vladikavkaz fort at the Darial Gorge, founded in 1784AD, and Caspian Derbent, annexed in 1806AD and confirmed at Gulistan in 1813AD, 9,5k), with recurring plague outbreaks (1804-1812AD in Kabarda) and Sheikh Mansur's 1785-1791AD war holding down highland growth [7][40].

Siberia and the North Pacific

Spanning 12,86M km^2 (69,5% of the 40-region land area), eighteenth-century Siberia and the North Pacific (Regions 34-40) doubled in population from 839k in 1721AD to 1,69M in 1815AD (+101%), turning from a seventeenth-century northern fur-tribute (*yasak*) colony into a belt of farming, silver-mining and overland China trade along its southern forest-steppe road [7][38][69].

In Western Siberia (Regions 34 and 35), traffic shifted south from the old Verkhoturye-Tobolsk river portage to the Great Siberian Post Road (*Trakt*) through Ekaterinburg, Tyumen, Ishim, Omsk, Kainsk and Tomsk in the 1730s-1760s, guarded against Kazakh raids by the Ishim and Irtysh Fortified Lines (with Omsk founded in 1716AD, reaching 6,5k in 1815AD). Southern Tobolsk, covering Tyumen, Kurgan, Ishim, Tara and Omsk (Region 34), grew by +153,5% from 215k in 1721AD to 545k in 1815AD, settled by free state peasants (*gosudarstvennye krestyane*), Old Believers and exiles around Tyumen (8,6k) and Tara (4,8k) [39][69]. By contrast, Northern Tobolsk and the Narym Ob-Irtysh taiga and tundra (Region 35) grew more slowly (+88,2%, from 85k to 160k), with old Tobolsk (11k to 15,4k) gradually losing trade to the southern road towns alongside Khanty, Mansi, Nenets and Selkup *yasak* districts around Berezov, Surgut, Obdorsk and Narym [38][39].

The fastest growth in Asian Russia took place in Tomsk Governorate (split from Tobolsk in 1804AD) and the Kolyvan-Voskresensk Altai Mining District (Region 36, expanding from 95k to 300k, or +215,8%) [69][70]. Started as Akinfiy Demidov's copper works in the 1720s and taken over in 1747AD by the Imperial Cabinet after rich silver ores were found at Zmeinogorsk (6,3k in 1815AD), the Altai silver smelters around Barnaul (founded in the 1730s, 8,2k in 1815AD) produced most of Russia's domestic silver coinage, worked by over 85k ascribed peasant households alongside Tomsk (5,2k to 10,5k), Biysk (3,3k) and Kuznetsk (2,4k) [5][70]. Along the mountainous Qing frontier after the 1755-1758AD Qing destruction of the Dzungar Khanate, the Altai-Sayan and Minusinsk borderlands (Region 37, rising from 75k to 125k, or +66,7%) brought Southern Altai and Khakas communities under regular tribute rolls [38][71].

In Central and Eastern Siberia (Regions 38, 39 and 40), Yeniseisk Province (Region 38, growing from 72k to

144k, or +100%) doubled along the Krasnoyarsk (2,4k to 5,1k) and Achinsk road whilst northern Yeniseisk (5,2k to 6,6k) and polar Turukhansk stagnated as sable stocks declined [69]. Eastward in Irkutsk Governorate and Transbaikalia (Region 39, rising from 142k to 252k, or +77,5%), the Treaty of Kiakhta (August 1727AD) fixed the Russo-Qing border and channelled Sino-Russian tea, rhubarb, cotton and fur trade through Kiakhta/Troitskosavsk (4,6k in 1815AD), turning Irkutsk (6,5k to 14,2k) into the administrative and commercial capital of Eastern Siberia, alongside Buryat steppe communities around Selenginsk (2,6k) and Verkhneudinsk (3,3k) and the Cabinet silver-lead mines at Nerchinsk (3,6k) [38][69]. Finally, across the 5,3M km^2 subarctic and Pacific expanse of Yakutsk, the Okhotsk Seaboard and Kamchatka (Region 40, moving from 155k in 1721AD to 115k in 1744AD and 160k in 1815AD, or +3,2%), cattle-keeping Yakuts (Sakha) around Yakutsk (1,8k to 3,1k) recovered to over 110k by 1815AD, whereas Yukaghir, Chukchi, Koryak and Itelmen communities suffered heavy epidemic losses during the decades of Vitus Bering's Kamchatka expeditions out of Okhotsk (1,8k) and Petropavlovsk-Kamchatsky (founded in October 1740AD) [38][72]. Above all, the 1768-1769AD Kamchatka smallpox epidemic killed ~5k-6k native inhabitants - more than half of the surviving Itelmen population - leaving the Far North-East barely above its 1721AD level by 1815AD [72][73].

Conclusion

Between 1721AD and 1815AD, the population across our 40 regions more than doubled from 23,89M to 51,17M, whilst the population within the borders of the Russian Empire (39 regions excluding Austrian Galicia) grew from 22,26M to 47,82M (+114,8%). This expansion reshaped the map of Eastern Europe and Northern Asia in three ways. First, inside European Russia, rapid rural natural increase shifted the demographic centre of gravity southward from the old forest belt toward the fertile Black-Earth provinces, the Lower Volga and the Ural ironworks. Second, outward conquest and the Three Partitions of Poland-Lithuania brought over 10M western and southern inhabitants under Russian rule, opening the Black Sea steppes of Novorossiya and Bessarabia to peasant and foreign colonist settlement and creating fast-growing ports led by Odessa. Third, despite severe setbacks - the 1770-1772AD plague in Moscow, the 1771AD Kalmyk exodus, the Pugachev rebellion and the loss of over 700k people across the western and central provinces during Napoleon's 1812AD invasion - the Russian Empire emerged at the Congress of Vienna as the most populous state in Europe.

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